A SYNOPSIS OF THE THESIS

ARTHĀPATTI AS A *PRAMĀṆA*: A DEFENCE

SUBMITTED FOR THE PARTIAL FULFILMENT OF THE REQUIREMENT FOR THE AWARD OF THE DEGREE OF

DOCTOR OF PHILOSOPHY (Ph. D.) IN PHILOSOPHY

TO

VISVA-BHARATI, SANTINIKETAN
(A Central University and an Institution of National Importance)

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REGISTRATION NO.: VB-2834 OF 2016-17

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SEPTEMBER, 2022

SYNOPSIS

The purpose of choosing the topic **"*Arthāpatti* as a *Pramāṇa*: A Defence"** in this Ph. D thesis is to find out whether *arthāpatti* (presumption) can be treated as an independent instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*) or reduced to *anumāna* (inference), and find out the cause for accepting *arthāpatti* (presumption) as an independent instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*). Among the Indian philosophers, Mīmāṁsakas (both Prābhākara and Bhāṭṭa) and Advaita Vedāntins, on the one hand, accept *arthāpatti* (presumption) as an independent *pramāṇa* (instrument of valid cognition); but Nyāya and Sāṁkhya philosophers, on the other hand, reduce *arthāpatti* (presumption) to *anumāna* (inference). The Nyāya school admits three sorts of inference viz. *kevalānvayī*, *kevala-vyatirekī*, and *anvaya-vyatirekī*. *Arthāpatti* (presumption) according to this school belongs to the second sort of *anumāna* (inference), i.e., *kevala-vyatirekī anumāna*. However, the Mīmāṁsā and the Advaita Vedānta schools do not accept *kevala-vyatirekī* (only of agreement in the absence) *anumāna* (inference). So, as there is no room for *kevala-vyatirekī* (only of agreement in the absence) *anumāna* (inference) in the philosophy of Mīmāṁsā and Advaita Vedānta schools, and again as *arthāpatti* (presumption) according to Nyāya school can only be reduced to *kevala-vyatirekī* (only of agreement in absence) *anumāna* (inference); it implies that *arthāpatti* (presumption) cannot be reduced to *anumāna* (inference). That is why they argue that *arthāpatti* (presumption) is an independent instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*). The Nyāya school has offered another argument on the ground of logical economy (*lāghava*) to show that *arthāpatti* (presumption) should be reduced to *anumāna* (inference). In this way, a long dialogue takes place between the Nyāya and Sāṁkhya schools on the one hand, and the Mīmāṁsā and the Advaita Vedānta schools on the other. An attempt to a critical analysis has been made on their views regarding the status of *arthāpatti* (presumption) in this thesis.

The thesis consists of six chapters:

Chapter-I: Introduction

Chapter-II: *Arthāpatti* in Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṁsā School

Chapter-III: *Arthāpatti* in Prābhākara Mīmāṁsā School

Chapter-IV: *Arthāpatti* in Advaita Vedānta School

Chapter-V: Sāṁkhya and Nyāya Critique on *Arthāpatti*

Chapter-VI: Concluding and Critical Remarks

The **first chapter** of this thesis, **'Introduction'**, contains the concept of valid cognition (*pramā*) and the instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*). In this universe, each and every human being acts to fulfill their purpose (*svaprayojana*). Human beings perform something keeping some *prayojana* or end-in-view of their own. One has to have the cognition to meet his *prayojana* (incentive). So, right or valid cognition is necessary to fulfill the goal, i.e., *prayojana* (incentive). Now, the question arises: what is right or valid cognition?

The very title of the thesis demands that we should discuss at least in brief what is meant by *pramā* (valid cognition) and *pramāṇa* (instrument of valid cognition). Therefore, an attempt has been made in this chapter to deal with the concept of *pramā* and *pramāṇa*. Indian philosophers have discussed the nature of *pramā* or valid cognition in different ways according to their metaphysical standpoint. The way one gets the valid cognition of an object is determined by certain *pramāṇa* (instrument of valid cognition). Hence, the number of *pramāṇa*-s differs from school to school in Indian philosophy. However, this chapter would restrict the view of Nyāya, Buddhist, Mīmāṁsā (Prābhākara and Bhāṭṭa), Advaita Vedānta, and Sāṁkhya schools regarding the nature of *pramā* and *pramāṇa*.

The **second chapter** entitled **'*Arthāpatti* in Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṁsā School'**, where the Bhāṭṭa views about the nature and classification of *arthāpatti* (presumption) has been dealt with. In this chapter, the view on *arthāpatti* has been placed followed by Śabara, Kumārila Bhaṭṭa, and Nārāyaṇa Bhaṭṭa.

The term *arthāpatti* (presumption) denotes both the *pramāṇa* and *pramā*. Etymologically the term '*arthāpatti*' is referred to as *pramāṇa* and *pramā* both. However, according to the *samāsa* (a kind of Sanskrit grammar), the term '*arthāpatti*' is analyzed differently to *arthāpatti pramāṇa* and *arthāpatti pramā.* '*Arthasya āpattiḥ yasmāt*' - here the etymological meaning of it implies the term '*arthāpatti*' as a *pramāṇa* used by *bahuvrīhi samāsa*. '*Arthasya āpattiḥ arthāpattiḥ*' - here the etymological meaning of it indicates the term '*arthāpatti*' as a *pramā* through *ṣaṣṭhi-tatpuruṣa samāsa*. The word '*arthāpatti*' is derived from the words '*artha*' and '*āpatti*'. The meaning of '*artha*' is the real object, and '*āpatti*' means imagination (*kalpanā*). So, *arthāpatti* is an assumption of something to resolve a contradiction.

Śabara, the commentator of *Mīmāṁsā-Sūtra*, defines *arthāpatti* as the assumption of something which is seen on the ground that a fact already perceived or heard would not be possible without that is called *arthāpatti* (presumption); for instance, it is found that Devadatta who is alive is not in the house, and this non-existence in the house leads to the presumption that he is somewhere outside the house.[1] By the term '*dṛṣṭaḥ śruto vā*', this definition of *arthāpatti* (presumption) implies that there are two sorts of *arthāpatti* (presumption) viz. *dṛṣṭārthāpatti* and *śrutārthāpatti*. Though there is a controversy regarding the classification of *arthāpatti* among the Bhāṭṭa and the Prābhākara of Pūrva-Mīmāṁsā school as both the schools explain Śabara's concept of *arthāpatti* based on a single example given by him. This controversy can be illustrated in this chapter.

Kumārila Bhaṭṭa describes *arthāpatti* (presumption), in his *Ślokavārttika*, as that which is assumed through remembrance or *śruti* and accepted the non-existent of meaning through the *liṇg.* The entailment of such a result is not possible without *arthāpatti*, because of the possibility of something which is not entailed by perception, inference, comparison, testimony, etc., but such type of entailment is also illustrious (*prasiddha*). Therefore, this kind of entailment is isolated with perception, etc., but they are accepted for illustriousness through reason. This type of assumption is called *arthāpatti* (presumption).

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[1] "*arthāpattirapi dṛṣṭaḥ śruto vā artho'anyathā nopapadyate ityarthakalpanā. yathā jībati Devadatte gṛhābhāvadarśanena vahirbhāvsyādṛṣṭasya kalpanā*." *Mīmāṁsā-Sūtra-Bhāṣya*:1-1-5.

Nārāyaṇa Bhaṭṭa in his *Mānameyodaya* says that whereas something is otherwise unintelligible, the assumption of what will make it intelligible is *arthāpatti* (presumption): this alone is the definition as given in the *Śabara-Bhāṣya*.[2] When it is known that Devadatta is alive, but he is not at home, then some inconsistency arises. This inconsistency can be resolved if we assume that he is outside. This type of assumption is called *arthāpatti* (presumption). Actually, the conflict between two instruments of valid cognition is called *arthāpatti*. Here, two instruments of valid cognition are: one is the general instrument of valid cognition, and another is the specific instrument of valid cognition. In the preceding example, Devadatta is alive is known by the general instrument of valid cognition, i.e., inference (*anumāna*), and the absence of Devadatta at home is known by the specific instrument of valid cognition, i.e., non-apprehension (*anupalabdhi*). The uncommon causal condition for the cognition of *arthāpatti* (presumption) is the conflict between two instruments of valid cognition. Nārāyaṇa Bhaṭṭa says, the cognition to remove the conflict between two instruments of valid cognition is called *arthāpatti* (presumption). Though the conflict in the case of *arthāpatti* (presumption) is apparent, not a real one.

Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṁsakas have accepted two sorts of *arthāpatti* (presumption) following the definition of *arthāpatti* by Śabara, viz. *dṛṣṭārthāpatti* or presumption from what is seen and *śrutārthāpatti* or presumption from what is heard.[3] The cause of *śrutārthāpatti* is only verbal testimony (*śabda*), not any other instrument of valid cognition. Whatever is different from *śrutārthāpatti* is called *dṛṣṭārthāpatti,* and the cause of *dṛṣṭārthāpatti* is any instrument of valid cognition other than verbal testimony (*śabda*). As the Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṁsakas accept six sorts of instrument of valid cognition, so they accept five (excluding verbal testimony) sorts of *dṛṣṭārthāpatti*. Thus, Kumārila has mentioned six sorts of *arthāpatti* (presumption) and those are discussed in this chapter. The six sorts of *arthāpatti* (presumption) are:

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[2] "*anyathānupapattyā yadupapādakakalpanam / tadarthāpattirityevaṁ lakṣaṇaṁ Bhāṣyabhāṣitam.*"

- Nārāyaṇa Bhaṭṭa, *Mānameyodaya*, Sridinanath Tripathi Nabatirtha (Ed.), Vol II, Sanskrit College, Kolkata, 1989, p. 195.

[3] "*dṛṣṭaḥ śruto vā*".

a) *Pratyakṣapūrvikā Arthāpatti* (based on perception),
b) *Anumānapūrvikā Arthāpatti* (based on inference),
c) *Upamānapūrvikā Arthāpatti* (based on comparison),
d) *Arthāpattipūrvikā Arthāpatti* (based on another presumption),
e) *Abhāvapūrvikā Arthāpatti* (based on non-apprehension), and
f) *Śrutārthāpatti* (based on verbal testimony).

The **third chapter** is entitled **'*Arthāpatti* in Prābhākara Mīmāṁsā School'**. The task of this chapter is to discuss the nature of *arthāpatti* critically followed by the Prābhākara Mīmāṁsā school and an attempt has been made to bring in light the debate between Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṁsā and Prābhākara Mīmāṁsā school regarding the classification of *arthāpatti*. The apocalyptic visions of the rejection of the *śrutārthāpatti* by Prābhākara Mīmāṁsā is presented with some substantive arguments. Finally, an observation has been made that the Prābhākara school is bound to accept the *śrutārthāpatti* like the *dṛṣṭārthāpatti* though they have denied such type of *arthāpatti* as per their metaphysical standpoint.

Prabhākara Miśra says in his commentary *Bṛhati* that *arthāpatti* (presumption) is the assumption of a fact for explaining another fact to resolve their conflict. The word 'conflict' means the impossibility of the existence of a thing without the existence of another thing. If this is the case, then it can easily be said that *arthāpatti* (presumption) is nothing but the inference of a cause from its effect, as the existence of an effect cannot be possible without its cause. Thus, it is seen that *arthāpatti* (presumption) is not a different instrument of valid cognition other than inference. But, according to Prābhākara, *arthāpatti* is, in fact, different from inference. *Arthāpatti* (presumption) is different from inference in the sense that the conclusion in inference is derived from the invariable concomitance (*vyāpti*). But the cognition of invariable concomitance (*vyāpti*) is not a condition of *arthāpatti* (presumption). Furthermore, Prabhākara says that whatever is the case of *arthāpatti* (presumption) is the reverse process of inference. We can illustrate this view like that: the process of thinking in inference is from the *anupapanna* to the *upapādaka* while in the case of *arthāpatti* (presumption) the process of thinking is from the *upapādaka* to the *anupapanna*.

Our discussion regarding the classification of *arthāpatti* can be more conceited if one tries to link it with what Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas mean by verbal cognition. The difficulty of the division of *arthāpatti* arises due to the non-acceptance of *laukika śabda* by the Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas. They only accept the *Vedic śabda*. That is why Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas refute *śrutārthāpatti*. The *Veda* is called a *śāstra*, and this is why the verbal cognition of Prābhākara Mīmāṁsaka is called *śāstra-pramāṇa*.

The **fourth chapter**, **'*Arthāpatti* in Advaita Vedānta School'**, deals with the discussion of the nature of *arthāpatti* (presumption) according to Advaita Vedānta school, classification of *arthāpatti* and why they have been admitted to *arthāpatti* (presumption) as an independent instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*). A discussion about the difference in the view between Advaita Vedānta and Bhāṭṭa schools has been placed at the end of this chapter.

Advaita Vedānta accepts *arthāpatti* (presumption) as an independent instrument of valid cognition to explain the *Vedāntic* texts. Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra defines *arthāpatti* (presumption) as 'the assumption of an explanatory fact (*upapādaka*) from a cognition of the thing to be explained (*upapādya*) – "*tatropapādya-jñānenopapādaka-kalpanamarthāpatti*".[4] Here, the cognition of the seen facts is the instrument, and the cognition of the unseen or assumed fact is the result. *Upapādya* is one that cannot be explained without assuming another fact. The fact which is assumed to explain *upapādya* is known as *upapādaka*[5]. We may illustrate this with the help of an example. The stoutness of a man who does not eat during day time (*pīno Devadatta divā na bhūñkte*) is inexplicable without the assumption of his eating at night. One who does not eat both day and night cannot be stout. Here, the stoutness of such a man in the absence of eating in the day time is called *upapādya*, and the assumption of eating at night is called *upapādaka*. So, the assumption of an explanatory fact from an unexplained fact is called *arthāpatti* (presumption).

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[4] Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra, *Vedānta-Paribhāṣā*, Panchanan Bhattacharya (Tr.), Srinath Bhavan, Contai, Medinipur, 1377 (BN), p. 214.

[5] "*jena vinā jadanupapannam tat tatropapādyam. yasyāvāve yasyānupapattistat tatropapādakam*." Ibid., p. 214.

Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra mentions two sorts of *arthāpatti* (presumption) like Kumārila Bhaṭṭa, viz. *dṛṣṭārthāpatti* (presumption from the seen) and *śrutārthāpatti* (presumption from the heard). *Arthāpatti,* which is based on an instrument of valid cognition other than testimony, is called *dṛṣṭārthāpatti*. *Śrutārthāpatti* again has been sub-divided into *abhidhānānupapatti* (inconsistency due to the failure of expression) and *abhihitānupapatti* (inconsistency due to the incongruity of the meaning).

The **fifth chapter** entitled **'Sāṁkhya and Nyāya Critique on *Arthāpatti*'**, concentrates the discussion on controversy among the different philosophers particularly regarding whether *arthāpatti* (presumption) should be treated as an independent instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*) or not. The view of the Sāṁkhya school has been placed first, and then, presented Nyāya views regarding this.

Vācaspati, like the Naiyāyikas, thinks that *arthāpatti* (presumption) should be treated as a case of *anumāna* (inference), *vyatirekī anumāna*. Vācaspati Miśra in his commentary called *Sāṁkhya-Tattvakaumudī*, explains the Sāṁkhya views in this regard. The well-known example of *arthāpatti*: when it is known that Devadatta is alive, but he is not at home, then some inconsistency arises. This inconsistency can be resolved if we assume that he is outside. This type of assumption is called *arthāpatti* (presumption). According to Vācaspati Miśra, Devadatta is a spatio-temporary limited being. It's the general rule of an object that, which is limited by space and time that the absence of it to a certain place implies the presence of the same in the other place. Our body is a living example of this type of object. In this case, the relation of invariable concomitance, which is otherwise called *vyāpti,* can easily be established. The very form of this invariable concomitance stands as follows,

> 'If an object is absent in a place at a particular time, then that object must be present in another place at that time.'

This rule is equally true in the case of Devadatta since he is a person confined within a particular place and time. More clearly, to say, the absence of living in Devadatta in a specific house at a specific time necessarily implies his presence at a particular place outside the house at the same time. Thus, it is seen that the cognition of the presence of Devadatta outside from house is attained through inference, but not through any other

instrument of cognition called *arthāpatti* (presumption). The Sāṁkhya philosophers hold that this inference can be formulated in the following way:

> 'Devadatta is outside the house because he is alive and absent from the house.'

The person who is alive and absent from the house is somewhere other than the house, like me. Thus, it is shown that the instrument of cognition called *arthāpatti* (presumption) can very well be reduced to *anumāna* (inference).

The Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas have countered this view of the Sāṁkhya. They argue that in the example in question, aliveness accompanied by the absence from the house stands for probans, but in fact, this type of probans cannot be genuine. By the very definition, probans is something which is already known. If the aliveness of Devadatta is taken as the probans who is already known, then the question comes what the instrument by which the aliveness of Devadatta is known. The existence of Devadatta outside the house also becomes a subject of doubt, and that is why it also cannot stand for probans. Again, the same question recurs: what is the instrument through which the doubts in question can be removed? According to the critics, the existence of Devadatta outside the house cannot be free from doubt before inference, and therefore, the existence of Devadatta outside the house cannot be recognized as probans. Thus, Prābhākara schools established that the instrument of cognition in question is not a case of inference.

Gautama, the founder of the *Nyāya-Sūtra*, has been discussed on *arthāpatti* (presumption) in and from verse no. 2-2-1 to 2-2-6 as a valid piece of cognition. However, he has denied the independency of its instrument. The commentator of the *Nyāya-Sūtra*, Vātsyāyana, says to illustrate the *arthāpatti* (presumption) that *arthāpatti* is called '*arthataḥ āpatti*'. Again, he has mentioned the meaning of the word '*āpatti*' as *prāpti*, and '*prāpti*' is illustrated as *prasaṇga*.[6] In the case where the specific meaning is said through the sentence, if there is raised the '*prasaṇga*' of meaning out of that, then the '*prasaṇga*' of meaning out of that is called *arthāpatti* (presumption). More

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[6] "*arthādāpattirarthāpattiḥ, āpattiḥ prāptiḥ prasaṇgaḥ*." *Nyāya-Sūtra-Bhāṣya*: 2-2-1.

specifically it is said that *arthāpatti* (presumption) is the entailment of one affair from the proclamation of another affair.

In this chapter, it has also discussed the nature of *anumāna pramāṇa* (inference) followed by Nyāya, Mīmāṁsā, and Advaita Vedānta schools. Three types of *anumāna pramāṇa* (inference) based on *vyāpti* and the discussion on *kevala-vyatirekī anumāna* have been placed here. The Mīmāṁsakas have refuted the *kevala-vyatirekī anumāna*. They have accepted *arthāpatti* in place of *kevala-vyatirekī anumāna*. The argument to refute *kevala-vyatirekī anumāna* is as follows: in inference, the *pakṣa* is used as a *viśeṣya* and *sādhya* is used as a *viśeṣaṇa*. The hill is treated as *pakṣa*, and the fire is treated as *sādhya* in the *anumāna* of '*parvato vahnimāna dhūmāt*'. In an *anumāna*, the *sādhya* should always be previously known as a *viśeṣaṇa* to a *viśeṣya*. But, in the case of *kevala-vyatirekī anumāna*, the *sādhya* is not previously known as a *viśeṣaṇa* to a *viśeṣya*. As the *sādhya* is unknown concerning its relation with the *hetu*, how the inferential cognition (*anumiti*) can confirm the *sādhya* to such inference? For example, the inferential formation: 'cognition is self-illuminating (*svaprakāśa*), because it has knowability (*jñānatva*)'. The self-illuminating (*svaprakāśatva*) character of cognition is not a case of previously known fact, i.e., *prasiddha*. But, according to Kumārila, cognitionhood is always inferable (*anumeya*). Hence, the *kevala-vyatirekī anumāna* is not possible due to the unavailability of instance/instances of self-illumination (*svaprakāśa*) in cases of cognition.

The view of Naiyāyika cannot be a proper one in respect of reduction *arthāpatti* (presumption) in *anumāna* (inference). This can be highlighted through the *Vedānta-Paribhāṣā*. Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra in his *Vedānta-Paribhāṣā* refutes the view of Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika philosophers regarding *arthāpatti* (presumption). He shows that *arthāpatti* (presumption) cannot be reduced to *anumāna* (inference). He says that if *arthāpatti* (presumption) is the case of an *anumāna* (inference), then it must be *anvayī* type (agreement in presence) or the *vyatirekī* type (agreement in absence). But, Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra shows that it cannot be an *anvayī* type of inference. For supporting the view that *arthāpatti* (presumption) is not an *anvayī* type, Naiyāyika, Annaṁbhaṭṭa also says, "… no Rule of positive concomitance, i.e. one supported by

instances of 'anvaya' or agreement in presence is available here".[7] Advaitins have said that *kevalānyī anumāna* is based on a metaphysical standpoint which is not at par with the Naiyāyikas metaphysical stand point. This can be illustrated by D.M. Dutta, "There can be no term which is all-pervasive, and the absence of which cannot be found anywhere. Brahman, as conceived by them, excludes all predicates and the absence of the so-called all-pervasive major term (like "knowable") can be shown at least in Brahman."[8] The *kevala-vyatirekī anumāna*, according to Niyāyikas, is generated when the probans (*hetu*) is only negatively related to its probandum (*sādhya*). But Advaitins argue that "An argument based on an invariable concomitance between the *absence* of the major term and the *absence* of the middle (as we have in a vyatireki induction) cannot, therefore, be called an anumāna [*anumāna*], though it may be a quite valid piece of knowledge. It should be given a separate name, viz. arthāpatti [*arthāpatti*]."[9] So, a *vyātirekī* type of *anumāna* cann't be treated as proper *anumāna*. There is no *anvaya-vyatirekī anumāna* as there is no existence of *vyatirekī anumāna*. However, Advaitins accept only one type of inference, i.e., *anvayi-rūpamātra*.

Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra has presented another sound argument to substantiate the view that *arthāpatti* (presumption) cannot be a case of inference. According to him, none of the cases of *arthāpatti* that we have mentioned earlier are followed by a subsequent cognition (*anuvyavasāya*) "I am inferring" (*anuminomi*), but on the contrary, we say "I am assuming" (*kalpayāmi or arthāpayāmi*)[10]. So, this argument proves, once again, that *arthāpatti* (presumption) is not a case of inference.

Finally, an effort has been made in the **concluding chapter** to substantiate the position that *arthāpatti* (presumption) is an independent instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*). In the concluding part of this thesis, it has been mentioned that there are contexts to accept *arthāpatti* (presumption) as an independent instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*). However, it is not wise to reduce *arthāpatti* into another

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[7] Annaṁbhaṭṭa, *Tarkasaṁgraha-Dīpikā on Tarkasaṁgraha*, Gopinath Bhattacharya (Tr. & Ed.), Progressive Publishers, Kolkata, 2009, p. 319.

[8] Datta, D. M. *The Six Ways of Knowing*, University of Calcutta, Kolkata, 2014, p. 187.

[9] Ibid., p. 187.

[10] Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra, *Vedānta-Paribhāṣā*, Panchanan Bhattacharya (Tr.), Srinath Bhavan, Contai, Medinipur, 1377 (BN), p. 220.

instrument of valid cognition taking logical economy (*lāghava*) as the sole cause at the cost of actual facts. A close scrutiny shows that *arthāpatti* (presumption) is an independent and separate instrument of valid cognition. Therefore, to deny *arthāpatti* (presumption) as an independent and separate instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*) is to deny the actual process of presumption. Moreover, each and every school of Indian philosophy is different in view regarding the number of instruments of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*) due to their metaphysical standpoint. Here, we have discussed such contexts one by one, and try to show instances for accepting *arthāpatti* (presumption) as an independent instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*).

Firstly, the law of *karma* is accepted by all the schools of Indian Philosophy except the Cārvāka school. The Mīmāṁsakas are of the opinion that the concept of *apūrva* is good enough in explaining the universe as a whole and the concept of God is redundant for the explanation of the universe. Those schools accept God actually accept two unseen powers: one is God, and the other one is the law of *karma* / *apūrva* / *adṛṣṭa*. But the Mīmāṁsakas accept only one such unseen power called *apūrva*. This power which is called *apūrva* itself is sufficient to explain the theory of action. Mīmāṁsakas have accepted *arthāpatti* (presumption) as an instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*) for explaining *apūrva*.

Secondly, Advaita Vedānta accepts *arthāpatti* (presumption) as an instrument of valid cognition to explain the *Vedāntic* texts. For example, the *Upaniṣad*-s describe the creation of this world with the help of *Brahman* and again it is stated that *Brahman* is alone real. This inconsistency is resolved by assuming that the creation of this world is not real, but apparent (*vivarta*) as the shell appears as silver. Here. Advaita Vedāntins assume the existence of *māyā* as the power of *Brahman* to resolve such conflict, and such type of assumption is called *arthāpatti* (presumption).

Thirdly, *arthāpatti* is also required to fill the semantical gap between sentences. There are cases where a semantical gap between sentences is observed, *arthāpatti* (presumption) has a role to resolve such types of semantical gaps. Therefore, one should accept *arthāpatti* (presumption) to fill the semantic gap between sentences.

Fourthly, *lakṣaṇā* is one sort of *vṛṭṭi* which is assumed to remove the inconsistency between a word and its meaning. *Arthāpatti* is applied to reconcile the

inconsistency of what is happening either directly or indirectly. So, from the above, we may say that *arthāpatti* is necessary to reconcile the inconsistency between a word and its meaning through *abhidhā* and *lakṣaṇā*. So, the metaphorical meaning of a sentence is the outcome of *arthāpatti pramāṇa*.

Fifthly, according to Kant, scientific knowledge has two necessary characteristics, viz. necessity and novelty. Kant, being a critique of both rationalists and empiricists, advocates for synthetic a-priori knowledge as scientific knowledge as it fulfills the criteria of having necessity and novelty in it. A critical analysis on the methods of Kant's philosophy shows that the conception of presumption is necessarily related to his philosophy as he has mentioned the two characteristics of scientific knowledge what is discussed earlier. *Arthāpatti* fulfills the necessary characteristics of knowledge, viz. necessity, and novelty.

Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṁsā and Advaita Vedānta schools, those schools accept necessity and novelty as the characteristics of valid cognition (*pramā*). The Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṁsā school defines valid cognition as "*pramā cājñātatattvārthajñānamevātra bhidyate*".[11] There are two characteristics that qualify this definition. First, *pramā* must be a cognition of an object which was not known previously (*ajñāta*),[12] that is there must be something new content in valid cognition what is called novelty in Kantian philosophy, and secondly, the cognition necessarily be of an object as it is (*tattva*) what is called necessity in Kantian philosophy. Like Nārāyaṇa Bhaṭṭa, Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra also defines *pramā* in his *Vedānta-Paribhāṣā* as "*tatra smṛti-vyāvṛttaṁ pramātvamanadhigatāvādhitārthaviṣayaka-jñānatvam*"[13]. According to this definition, *pramā* (valid cognition) is different from *smṛti* (remembrance) and is characterized by twofold properties of truth (*avādhitārtha*) and novelty (*anadhigata*) that is compared with the necessity and novelty of Kant's philosophy.

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[11] Nārāyaṇa Bhaṭṭa, *Mānameyodaya*, Sridinanath Tripathi Nabatirtha (Ed.), Vol II, Sanskrit College, Kolkata, 1989, p. 2.

[12] "*ajñātapadenātra jñātabiṣaiayoḥ sṛtyanubādayornirāsaṁ*." Ibid., p. 6.

[13] Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra, *Vedānta-Paribhāṣā*, Panchanan Bhattacharya (Tr.), Srinath Bhavan, Contai, Medinipur, 1377 (BN), pp. 7-9.

We assume the existence of the forms of thought and *noumena* for Kant and *māyā* for Advaitins through *arthāpatti*. So, there is a conceptual similarity. But the difference is: Advaitins have accepted *arthāpatti* as an instrument of valid cognition, whereas Kant, is bound to accept the existence of the forms of thought and noumena through such type of instrument of valid cognition.

Sixthly, in this mundane world, there are sentences that are used by different eminent poets or creative persons which may appear as meaningless. Such types of sentences become meaningful when they are understood through the help of *arthāpatti* (presumption). For example, the sentence "*āmāke āmār mato thākte dāo*…" a word-to-word meaning may be translated as "let me stay as myself" which does not convey anything significant. Let us explain. The first '*āmā*', i.e., '*āmāke*' denotes the embodied self, having some relation with society. But the second '*āmā*', i.e., '*āmār*' indicates being as such which is the dis-embodied self as such, self as such. Now it is clear that both types of '*āmā*' are not equal meaning. If so, how can such type difference be known and make the sentence meaningful? Such type of inconsistency can be removed if we assume both types of '*āmā*' as different, i.e., the first '*āmā*' denotes the embodied self and the second '*āmā*' indicates the dis-embodied self. By employing *arthāpatti* the meaning of the mentioned sentence may convey "I am a little with myself want to meet up …" that is, the embodied self is wanted to be like the dis-embodied self. We have vehemently used such types of sentences in our daily life as well as in literature also. Such types of sentences cannot be produced in any sense otherwise the acceptance of *arthāpatti* (presumption).

Last, but not least, *arthāpatti* cannot be reduced to *anumāna* because there is no element of apparent conflict in the valid form of inference, but there is an element of apparent conflict or inconsistency in *arthāpatti* (presumption). *Arthāpatti* (presumption) starts its journey from the very conflict of a known fact. This is not true in the case of inference. Inference starts its journey with the cognition of the probans (*liṅga*) in the subject (*pakṣa*). Besides this, the very aim of the journey of *arthāpatti* (presumption) is to resolve the conflict in question. But inference aims to reach the cognition of the probandum (*sādhya*). According to D. M. Datta,

> "Inference and postulation [presumption] – anumāna and arthapātti [*arthāpatti*] – are two opposite, and yet complementary processes. The first tries to find out what *follows* from given premises, whereas the second tries to find out what is *presupposed* by the given and explains the given by showing its grounds".[14]

What exactly we want to say is that our goal is to know reality through the instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*). Now, if we are found a simple process to establish reality then we should avoid the complex process. Here, Advaita Vedāntins accept *arthāpatti* (presumption) to establish their metaphysical position. So, *arthāpatti* (presumption) is accepted by Mīmāṁsā and Advaita Vedānta schools as an independent and separate instrument of valid cognition according to their metaphysical standpoint. Hence, one should accept *arthāpatti* (presumption) as an epistemological instrument by which an object can be known.

From the aforesaid discussion, we can say that *arthāpatti* (presumption) is not only different from inference; but also, is an independent instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*). When an instrument of cognition can be recognized as a *pramāṇa* is purely dependent upon the fact that whether cognition ascertained through it is valid or not. No one including the Naiyāyikas, the champions of logic, questions the validity of the cognition ascertained through *arthāpatti* (presumption). In the stock example, no one doubts the fact that Devadatta is outside of his house. Thus, it is proved that *arthāpatti* (presumption) is an independent and separate instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*).

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[14] Datta, D. M. *The Six Ways of Knowing*, University of Calcutta, Kolkata, 2014, p. 206.